

Three-Point Perspective

Dramatic angles & extreme views

Three-point perspective adds a third vanishing point, usually above or below the scene. It handles extreme viewing angles — looking up at a skyscraper or down from a great height — and adds dynamic energy to a composition.

KEY CONCEPTS

The Third Point

The third VP is placed either directly above the scene (for a worm's-eye view, looking up) or directly below it (for a bird's-eye view, looking down). All vertical lines now converge to this point instead of remaining parallel.

When It's Natural

3PP appears in any scene where you're tilting your camera dramatically up or down. Photographing a tall building from the street — that's 3PP. Looking down into a pit — 3PP. Most everyday scenes don't need 3PP.

Constructing in 3PP

Same as 2PP but all three sets of lines have a vanishing point. Work from a center vertical edge and send lines to all three VPs. The result should feel dramatic and dynamic — if it looks too extreme, your VPs are too close.

Using It Sparingly

3PP is powerful but can easily feel gimmicky or distorted. Reserve it for intentional dramatic effect. Comics, concept art, and architectural presentations use it for impact — don't use it for casual still lifes.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Draw a tall skyscraper viewed from street level in 3PP (worm's eye).
2. Draw a bird's eye view of a city block in 3PP.
3. Draw the same box in 1PP, 2PP, and 3PP — compare the results.

FURTHER READING

■ CTRL+Paint – 3 Point Perspective

<https://www.ctrlpaint.com/videos/linear-perspective>

■ Proko – Perspective Overview

<https://youtu.be/nAlCyQqEZSU>